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EVERYTHING EVERYWHERE ALL AT ONCE

UNFINISHED LECTURE NOTES

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These notes are, by their very nature, unfinished, and they improve with every reader. If you spot an error, disagree with a framing, or want to add a source, a question, or a position, open a pull request at https://github.com/Quillstacks/LectureMaterial/tree/main/lecturenotes/notes_everythingeverywhereallatonce. Every contribution is welcome.



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Introduction

EVERYTHING EVERYWHERE ALL AT ONCE is the working title for these notes. Replace this introduction with the actual framing once the course outline settles.

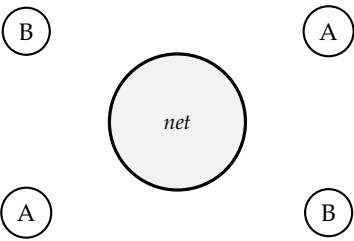
Spikeball

2026-05-08 · local draft

VOLLEYBALL, INVERTED

TWO AGAINST TWO. Four players stand around a small round trampoline on the ground. A team has up to three touches to return the ball to the net; once it leaves the net the court is 360 degrees and players move freely.

Players	2 vs. 2.
Equipment	Circular net, small inflatable ball.
Objective	Hit the ball onto the net so the opponents cannot legally return it.
Scoring	Rally scoring; standard play to 21, win by 2.



FAULTS END THE RALLY: more than three touches, the ball striking the rim instead of the net, a return that fails to clear the rim, or a double touch by a single player. Game ends at the target score with a margin of two.

ROUNDNET, COMMONLY SPIKEBALL
Invented by Jeff Knurek (1989)
Re-launched by Spikeball Inc. (2008)



WHY HERE.
A game whose entire ruleset fits on a single page, and whose physics demands that you know where everyone is at once.

EQUIPMENT. A circular frame roughly 90 cm in diameter with a taut elastic net stretched across it, plus a small inflatable ball about the size of a fist.

HINDER. A receiver must be granted a clear path to the ball after the serve. If a server blocks the line of play, the point is replayed without penalty.

TAKE IT FROM HERE. A small ruleset, an asymmetric topology, no walls. The same recipe shows up in much harder problems, just with different balls.